1.2 Station-As-Customer - Radio Is a Market, Not a Favor

Elite private strategy - not for redistribution

WAR-ROOM NOTES - 1.2 Station-As-Customer

THE REAL CUSTOMER IS THE FORMAT, NOT THE PD

This is the nuance that separates operators from amateurs. The PD is a gatekeeper, but the customer is the format. Formats are machine-like: they have tempo windows, energy floors, lyric rules, and rotation math. When you sell to the PD, you're selling to an agent of the format. When you present a product that fits the format without the PD having to argue for it internally, you've removed the risk - because the PD can point to the product and say "it belongs here." That is why format scoring (Module 2) comes before any pitch. You can't sell to a customer you haven't studied.

THE CLOCK IS THE HIDDEN SCORECARD

Every hour of radio is a fixed inventory: intro, hit, oldie, local, specialty, bed. The PD has ~9-11 slots per hour and 3-5 decisions per slot. Your product competes not against other artists' music, but against already-loaded confidence - songs the program team has proven. The only way an unknown wins a slot is by offering something the current inventory cannot: a local story, a listener story, a date, a guest spot. That's why Story and Risk are the two columns where independents actually win. Format fit gets you in the room. Story and low risk get you in the rotation.

THE FIVE-NEED SCORE (MEMORIZE IT)

- Format fit - 30% of the decision.
- Clock fit - 20%.
- Listener fit - 20%.
- Story/timing - 20%.
- Risk - 10%.

The amateurs spend 100% of their effort on #3 ("they'll love it!") and nothing on #4 and #5 - which is exactly why they lose to worse songs with better stories.

THE PROOF DILEMMA - AND ITS ONLY SOLUTION

A stranger who says yes to an unknown risks their judgment in front of their team. You cannot remove that risk with passion. You remove it with third-party evidence: plays, spins, streams, press, audience numbers. That is why Lesson 1.3 exists - and why you do it before you ever send another email.